

6.4 Assessment information

1 Examination overview

The assessment of this unit is through a 2 hour examination paper set and marked by Edexcel.

There are three sections in the examination paper: Section A: Aural Analysis; Section B: Music in Context, and Section C: Continuity and Change in Instrumental Music. Section A requires candidates to listen to extracts of music and one CD* per examination centre will be provided by Edexcel. A skeleton score is provided for use in Section A.

Candidates are given five minutes' reading time at the start of the examination.

Each candidate should have access to an unmarked copy of the anthology during the examination.

2 Section A: Aural Analysis (28 marks)

In this section, candidates listen to excerpts of unfamiliar music which are related to the two compulsory areas of study, *Instrumental Music* and *Applied music*.

Question 1 (10 marks) requires candidates to compare and contrast two excerpts of music. Candidates demonstrate their skills of aural analysis by comparing the musical features of the excerpts and placing the music in context (which could include identifying the genre, composer and date of composition). Each excerpt will be played three times each, in the order A, B; A, B; A, B. No score will be provided.

Question 2 (18 marks) requires candidates to listen to a single excerpt of music. Students demonstrate their skills of aural analysis by recognising chords and keys (as outlined in the harmonic and tonal vocabulary in *Section 6.2*), placing the music in context (which could include identifying the genre, composer, and date of composition) and completing simple aural dictation tasks. The excerpt for Question 2 will be played five times and a single- or two-stave skeleton score will be provided.

The excerpts of music will be punctuated by pauses, enabling candidates to complete their answers. The length of all pauses will be announced on the CD so that candidates can plan their time effectively.

*(plus a spare copy)

3 Section B: Music in Context (26 marks)	Questions in this section relate to the set works in Area of study 3: <i>Applied music</i>. Candidates answer two questions (13 marks each) from a choice of three. The questions prompt candidates to identify given musical features from selected set works and comment on how these features help to place the work in a social and historical context. Answers may be in note form or continuous prose.
4 Section C: Continuity and change in instrumental music (36 marks)	Questions in this section relate to the Area of study 1: Instrumental music and assess candidates understanding of continuity and change within the group of set works studied. Candidates will answer one essay question (36 marks) from a choice of two. Questions focus on one or more musical feature(s) (such as resources, form, texture, tonality, harmony, melody and rhythm and metre), and prompt candidates to demonstrate how these musical features illuminate continuity and change between works. Questions require candidates to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding in a variety of ways including comparing, contrasting, assessing, evaluating and commenting on set works as appropriate. In Section C, answers must be written in continuous prose. Quality of written communication (clarity of expression, structure and presentation of ideas, grammar, punctuation and spelling) will be taken into account when examiners mark Section C.

D Assessment and additional information

Assessment information

Assessment requirements	For a summary of assessment requirements and assessment objectives. Please see Section B, <i>Specification Overview</i> .
Entering students for this qualification	Details of how to enter students for the examinations for this qualification can be found in Edexcel's Information Manual, copies of which are sent to all examinations officers. The Information Manual can also be found on Edexcel's website (www.edexcel.com).
Resitting of units	There is no limit to the number of times that a student may retake a unit prior to claiming certification for the qualification. The best available result for each contributing unit will count towards the final grade. After certification all unit results may be reused to count towards a new award. Students may re-enter for certification only if they have retaken at least one unit. Results of units held in the Edexcel unit bank have a shelf life limited only by the shelf life of this specification.
Awarding and reporting	The grading, awarding and certification of this qualification will comply with the requirements of the current GCSE/GCE Code of Practice, which is published by the Office of Qualifications and Examinations Regulation (Ofqual). The AS qualification will be graded and certificated on a five-grade scale from A to E. The full GCE Advanced level will be graded on a six-point scale A* to E. Individual unit results will be reported. A pass in an Advanced Subsidiary subject is indicated by one of the five grades A, B, C, D, E of which Grade A is the highest and Grade E the lowest. A pass in an Advanced Level GCE subject is indicated by one of the six grades A*, A, B, C, D, E of which Grade A* is the highest and Grade E the lowest. To be awarded an A* students will need to achieve an A on the full GCE Advanced level qualification and an A* aggregate of the A2 units. Students whose level of achievement is below the minimum judged by Edexcel to be of sufficient standard to be recorded on a certificate will receive an unclassified U result.

Performance descriptions

Performance descriptions give the minimum acceptable level for a grade. See *Appendix 1* for the performance descriptions for this subject.

Unit results

The minimum uniform marks required for each grade for each unit:

Unit 1

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 90	72	63	54	45	36

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–35.

Unit 2

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 90	72	63	54	45	36

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–35.

Unit 3

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 120	96	84	72	60	48

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–47.

Unit 4

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 90	72	63	54	45	36

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–35.

Unit 5

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 90	72	63	54	45	36

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–35.

Unit 6

Unit grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 120	96	84	72	60	48

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–47.

Qualification results

The minimum uniform marks required for each grade:

Advanced Subsidiary GCE Cash-in code 8MU01

Qualification grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 300	240	210	180	150	120

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–119.

Advanced Level GCE Cash-in code 9MU01

Qualification grade	A	B	C	D	E
Maximum uniform mark = 600	480	420	360	300	240

Students who do not achieve the standard required for a Grade E will receive a uniform mark in the range 0–239

Language of assessment

Assessment of this specification will be available in English only. Assessment materials will be published in English only and all work submitted for examination and moderation must be produced in English.

Quality of written communication

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- write legibly, with accurate use of spelling, grammar and punctuation in order to make their meaning clear
- select and use a form and style of writing appropriate to purpose and to complex subject matter
- organise relevant information clearly and coherently, using specialist vocabulary when appropriate.

Students will be given the opportunity to demonstrate quality of written communication in Units 2 and 6.

Assessment objectives and weighting

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Interpret musical ideas with technical and expressive control and a sense of style and awareness of occasion and/or ensemble (performing/realising).	30%	30%	30%
AO2	Create and develop musical ideas with technical control and expressive understanding making use of musical devices, conventions and resources (composing/arranging).	30%	30%	30%
AO3	Demonstrate understanding of and comment perceptively on, the structural expressive and contextual aspects of music (appraising).	40%	40%	40%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Synoptic assessment

In synoptic assessment focus should be on the quality of assessment to ensure that it encourages the development of an holistic understanding of the subject.

Synopticity requires students to connect knowledge, understanding and skills acquired in different parts of the Advanced GCE course.

Synoptic assessment in the context of music requires students to make links between the performance, composition and historical aspects of music.

Stretch and challenge

Students can be stretched and challenged in A2 units through the use of different assessment strategies, for example:

- having a variety of stems in the questions used — for example analyse, evaluate, discuss, compare
- having a requirement for extended writing
- in Units 4 and 5 students can perform or compose to an outstanding level which is reflected in the top mark descriptor
- in Unit 6, students will need to show deeper knowledge of the historical and contextual aspects of music
- improvement of synoptic assessment.

Additional information

Malpractice and plagiarism

For up-to-date advice on malpractice and plagiarism, please refer to the latest *Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) Instructions for Conducting Coursework* document. This document is available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk.

For additional information on malpractice, please refer to the latest *Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) Suspected Malpractice in Examinations And Assessments: Policies and Procedures* document, available on the JCQ website.

Access arrangements and special requirements

Edexcel's policy on access arrangements and special considerations for GCE, GCSE, and Entry Level is designed to ensure equal access to qualifications for all students (in compliance with the Equality Act 2010) without compromising the assessment of skills, knowledge, understanding or competence.

Please see the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) website (www.jcq.org.uk) for their policy on access arrangements, reasonable adjustments and special considerations.

Please see our website (www.edexcel.com) for:

- the forms to submit for requests for access arrangements and special considerations
- dates to submit the forms.

Requests for access arrangements and special considerations must be addressed to:

Special Requirements
Edexcel
One90 High Holborn
London WC1V 7BH

Equality Act 2010

Please see our website (www.edexcel.com) for information on the Equality Act 2010.

Prior learning and progression

Prior learning

Students who would benefit most from studying a GCE in Music are likely to have a Level 2 qualification such as a GCSE in Music at grades A*C or a BTEC First Certificate or First Diploma in Music.

Progression

This qualification supports progression into further education, training or employment, such as a degree in music or vocational courses such as a BTEC HND or HNC in Music.

Combinations of entry

There are no forbidden combinations.

Student recruitment

Edexcel's access policy concerning recruitment to our qualifications is that:

- they must be available to anyone who is capable of reaching the required standard
- they must be free from barriers that restrict access and progression
- equal opportunities exist for all students.

The wider curriculum

This qualification provides opportunities for developing an understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social and cultural issues, together with an awareness of citizenship, environmental issues, health and safety considerations, and European developments consistent with relevant international agreements relevant to music. *Appendix 2* maps the opportunities available.